

Institute on Disability/UCED



University of
New Hampshire

Digital Badging

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Inclusive Higher Education University of New Hampshire

The **mission** of the Granite State TPSID is to build capacity for inclusive, authentic campus-life experiences in higher education for young adults with intellectual disabilities that result in credential attainment, competitive, integrated employment outcomes; increased independence, and high quality of life outcomes.





Learning Objectives

- UNH-4U program overview
- Operating definitions of digital badges
- Alignment with a program of study
- Validating skills and competencies
- Transferability to career pathway
- Value equation



UNH-4U Student Status

- Registered as Continuing Education
- Audit mode
- Maximum of 11 credits per semester
- 1:3 credit to clock hour ratio
- Self-determined program of study
- First cohort impacts 6 colleges
- Fully inclusive residential option
- Strong interagency collaboration



What are Digital Badges?

- An electronic representation of a skill, achievement, or experience.
- Detailed information about activities or assessments the learner completed
- Successful completion of a variety of learning experiences in credit and non-credit work
- Sharing of badges are learner controlled and open across social media, blogs, online portfolios, and others.



What are Digital Badges?

- “...students significantly improve their knowledge, confidence, and experience in properly using common laboratory glassware and equipment” (Hensiek et al., 2017).
- “The work IBM had done to define the competencies and criteria for earning each digital badge made the learning outcomes significantly clearer and easier for Northeastern faculty to assess,” (Leaser et al., 2020).
- “Digital badges allowed for the modularization of what had been larger certification programs into smaller pieces that were easier to update and mapped more specifically to specialized skills and job roles,” (Leaser et al., 2020).



What are Digital Badges

- Pellissippi State Community College enrollment increased 44% and completion of programs tracked at 85% due to the college's implementation of stacked credentials that build off of previous session blocks to seamlessly move through a pathway/program (Perea, B., 2020).
- Survey data indicates the majority of participants shared their earned credentials on social media sites (LinkedIn); added to job sites (Indeed), resume, business card; and informed employer, peers, and customers.
- Benefits for the issuers: enhances the marketing of the brand, which may ultimately lead to further recognition of the company.
- Participants were highly likely to recommend the program, felt as though the badge program strengthened their skills, and promoted successful completion.



Implications of Digital Badges

- Allows for modularization to specific skills sets or entry points for learning pathways
- Relies on very clear specifications, criteria for skills and competencies that badges represent
- Provides “market intelligence” for faculty to know in-demand skills as well as highlights “fit” between the badge holder and the desired employment.



Badge Levels

- Level 1: Foundational
- Level 2: Intermediate
- Level 3: Advanced
- Level 4: Competency



Badging Taxonomy-Learner Assessment

- Association (2 levels): Participation and/or Recognition Badges
- Learning (2 Levels): Grade Based and/or Level Program Badge
- Competency & Validation (2 Levels): Performance Badge;
Certification or Licensure



Transferability to Career Pathways

Career-Specific Knowledge and Skills			21 st Century Work-Related Skills			
Academic Enrichment	Career Development		Social Development		Independent Living	
Foundation Content	Practicum Independent Study	Internship	Career and Social Networks	Social Interactions	Self Advocacy Determination	Individual Goals



Alignment with Program of Study

- Person Centered Plan
- O*Net Codes: required knowledge and skills are mapped to course options and program of study
- Class selection and faculty request
- Cross walk between syllabi and badging taxonomy
- Students included in regular undergraduate classes and assignments
- Faculty assess competencies learner's performance on the class assigned work



Vertical & Horizontal Stacking

Information Media and Technology Skills

Information Literacy	Media Literacy	Information Communications Technology
Create Media Products	Create Media Products	Apply Technology Effectively
Analyze Media	Analyze Media	



Transferability to Career Pathways

Physical Education			21 st Century Work-Related Skills			
Pedegogy National Standards	Career Development		Social Development		Independent Living	
	Lesson plans Co-teaching Rules of sports	Rec Department Elementary School	Student Organizations Res Life	Etiquette	Self Advocacy & Self Determination	Individual Goals



Value Equation

- The cost of higher education and return on investment – priceless
- Alignment with evidence, university practice, and workforce demands
- Allow to customize to desired standard or modality
- Transferability into job market and customized, competitive employment in career pathway learners self-direct and stakeholder buy-into.
- Applies to real world learning in an authentic campus life experience.

Photo credit: Jeremy Gasowski



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